

Navigating between Views



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Users need a way to trigger navigation events.



RouterLink Directive

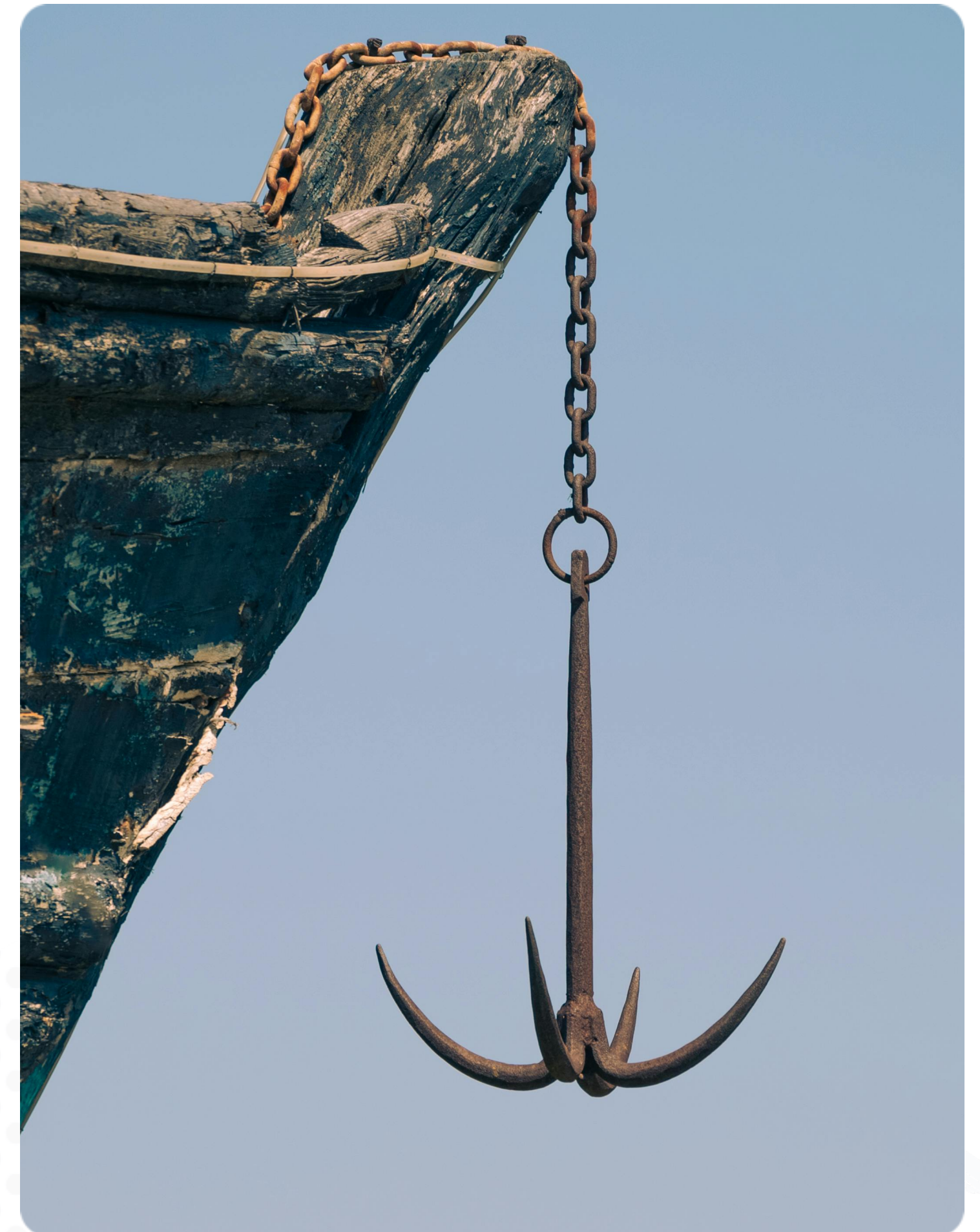
Replaces the href attribute of anchor tags

Can be used on other elements

It is an accessibility best practice to use RouterLinks with native navigation elements

Used to declare navigation instructions

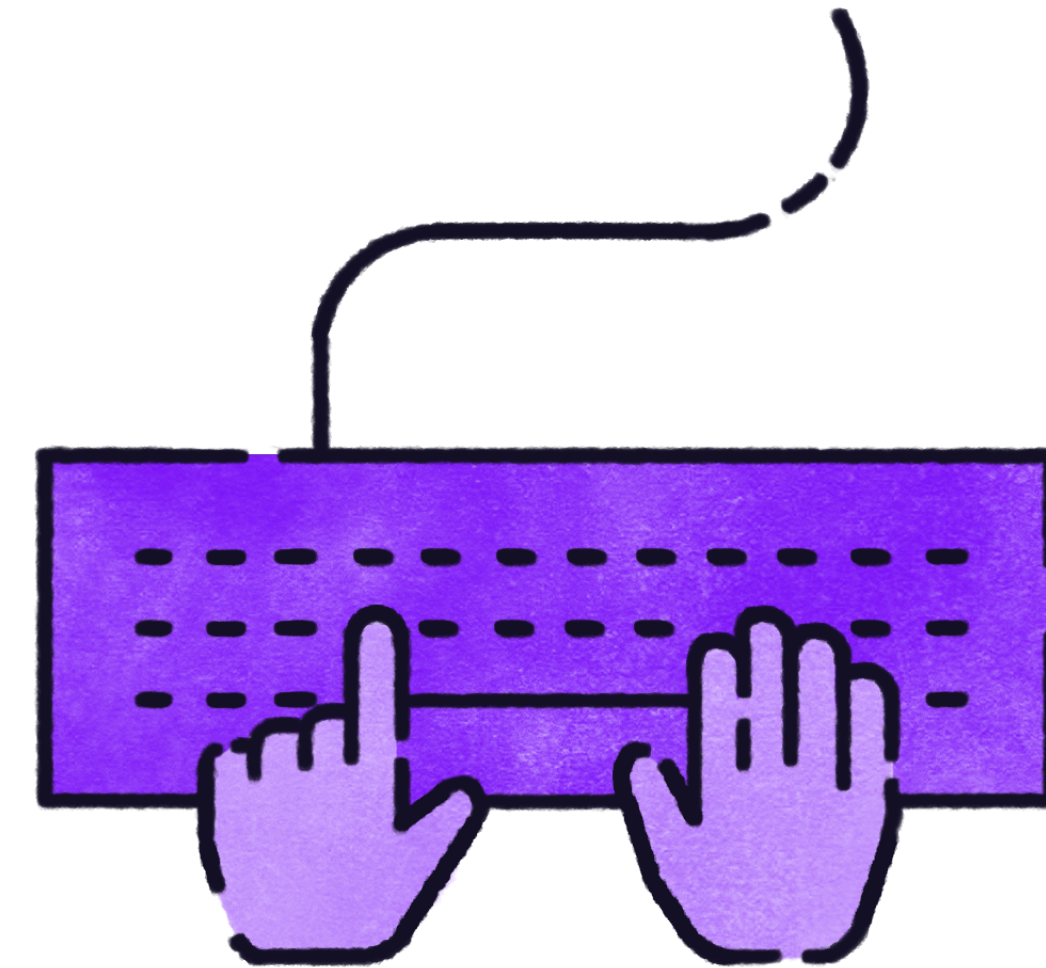
Can handle basic or complex navigation tasks



Navigation and URL Paths



**Routes read path
segments from the URL**



**RouterLinks add path
segments to the URL**



Declaring RouterLink Paths

```
routerLink="products"
```

```
// add a single segment with a string
```

```
[routerLink]="PRODUCTS_PATH"
```

```
// add a single segment with a dynamic property
```

```
routerLink="products/detail"
```

```
// add multiple segments by concatenating segments
```

```
routerLink=["products", DETAIL_PATH]"
```

```
// add multiple segments in an array
```



Updating the URL with the Router

Absolute route

Replaces the existing URL path

Indicate an absolute route by providing a slash as the first character of the path

`"/products/details"`

vs.

Relative route

Adds to the existing URL Path

No leading slash or `./` appends the path to the end of the existing path

`"products/detail"`

`"./products/detail"`

Two dots and a slash removes a single path segment

`"../products/detail"`

`"../../products/detail"`



Relative routes can be more flexible, but choosing which to use depends on the needs of the application.

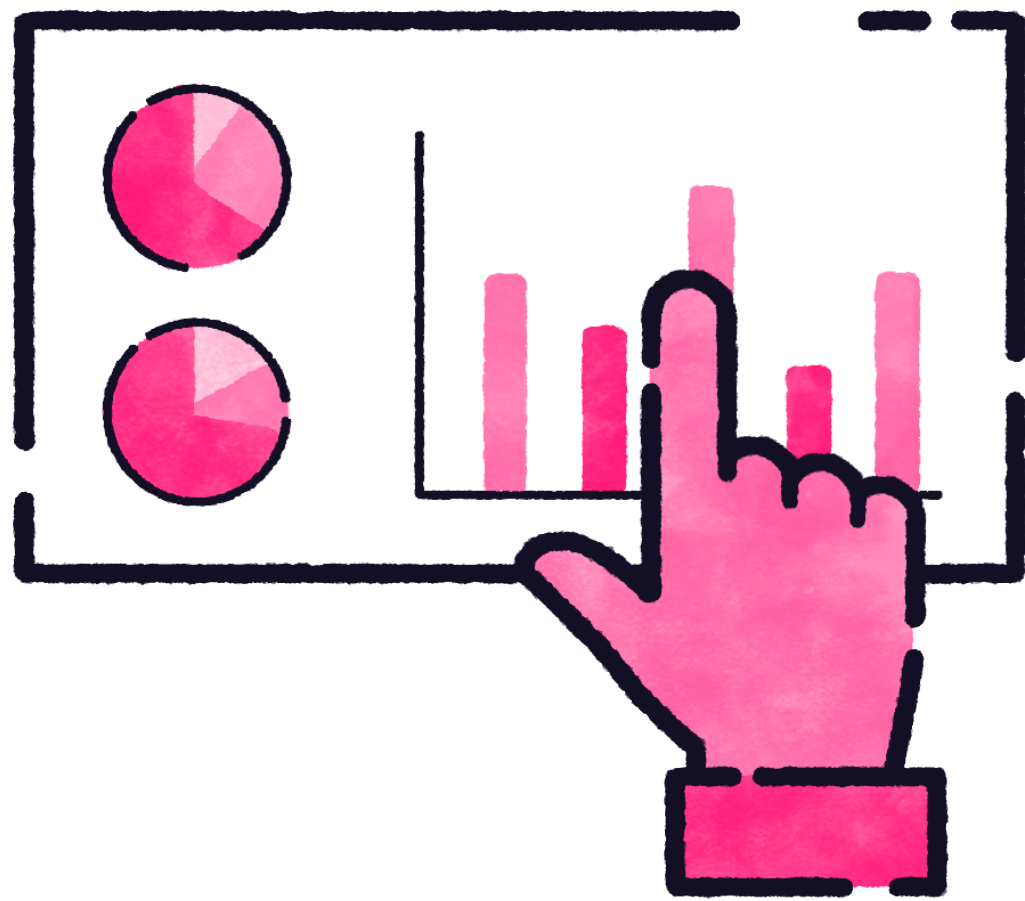




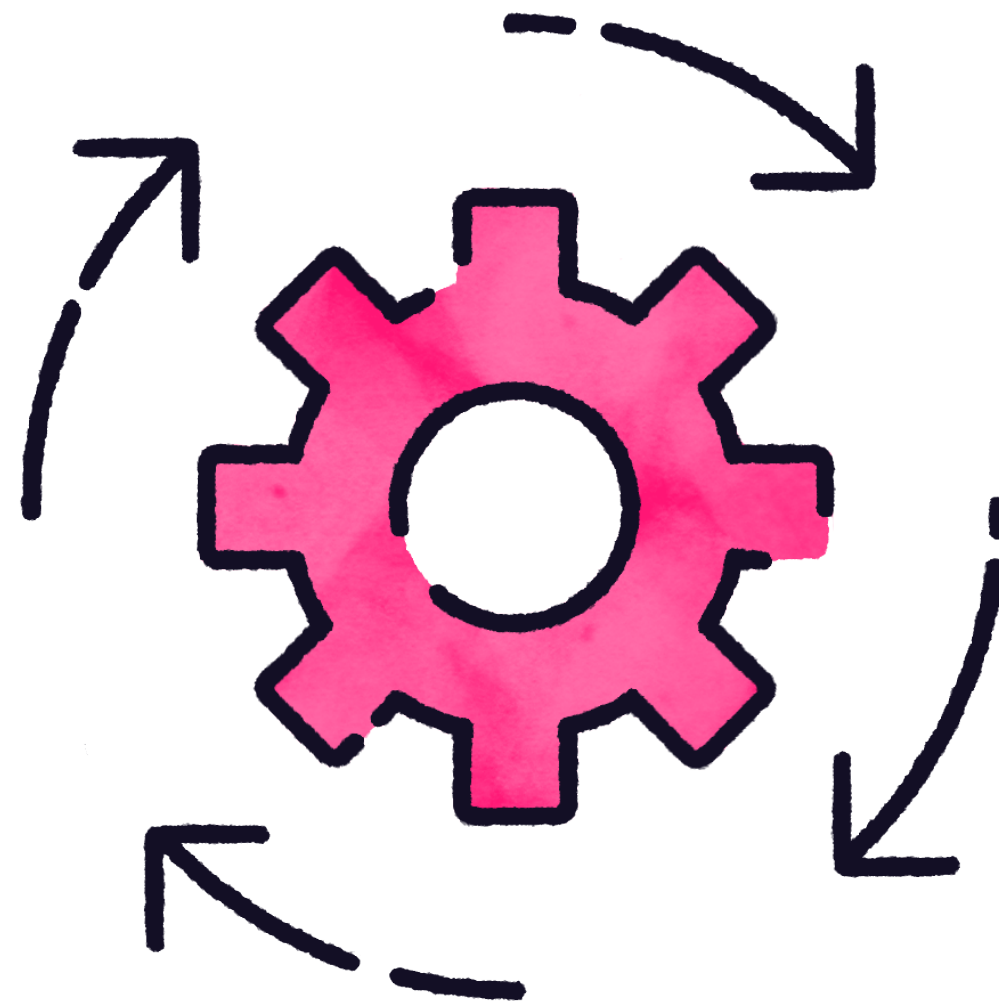
Declaring route token constants helps prevent mismatched paths and makes refactoring easier



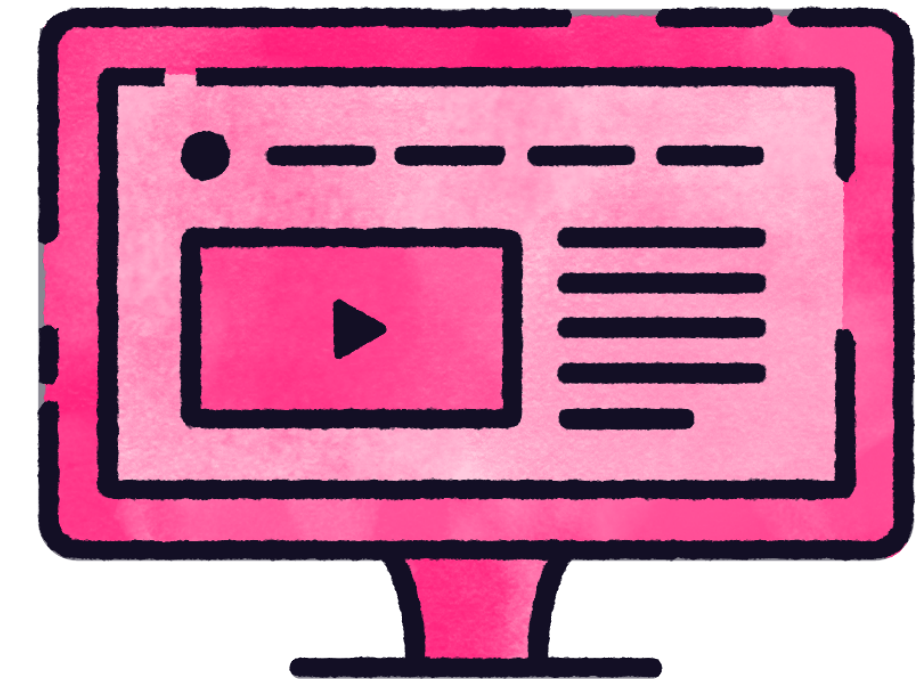
RouterLinks in Action



User clicks an element



RouterLink initiates a navigation event with the router service



The router service updates the URL and the view



Demo: Implementing RouterLinks



Troubleshooting RouterLinks

Incorrectly updated URLs are usually related to
relative versus absolute routes

Errors and debugging are available in the console





Styling Active Links





RouterLinkActive Directive

Applied to any element that contains a RouterLink directive

Adds a class to the element when the activated route matches the router link

Can apply single classes, classes separated by spaces, or an array of classes



Styling Parent Elements

Parent elements with RouterLinkActive are styled when any of the child links are active



ariaCurrentWhenActive

An input of the RouterLinkActive directive

Sets the aria-current attribute on the element

Pass the string “page” to indicate to assistive technologies that the link is the active view



Navigating Programmatically





Navigation might not be initiated in the template

Navigation might be triggered by code



Navigating Programmatically with the Router

`navigateByUrl`

- Navigates using an absolute route path
- Used under the hood by RouterLink
- Requires a path string or UrlTree
- Accepts an optional NavigationBehaviorOptions object that can pass state or alter browser history

vs.

`navigate`

- Can perform relative navigation with a starting point
- Requires an array of path segments
- Accepts an optional NavigationExtras object that can pass query parameters, set a starting point, pass state, or alter browser history



Under the hood, the navigate method is a wrapper around the navigateByUrl method.





Users can now navigate through different routes by clicking on page elements

For more practice, try adding RouterLinks to the BreadcrumbsComponent

